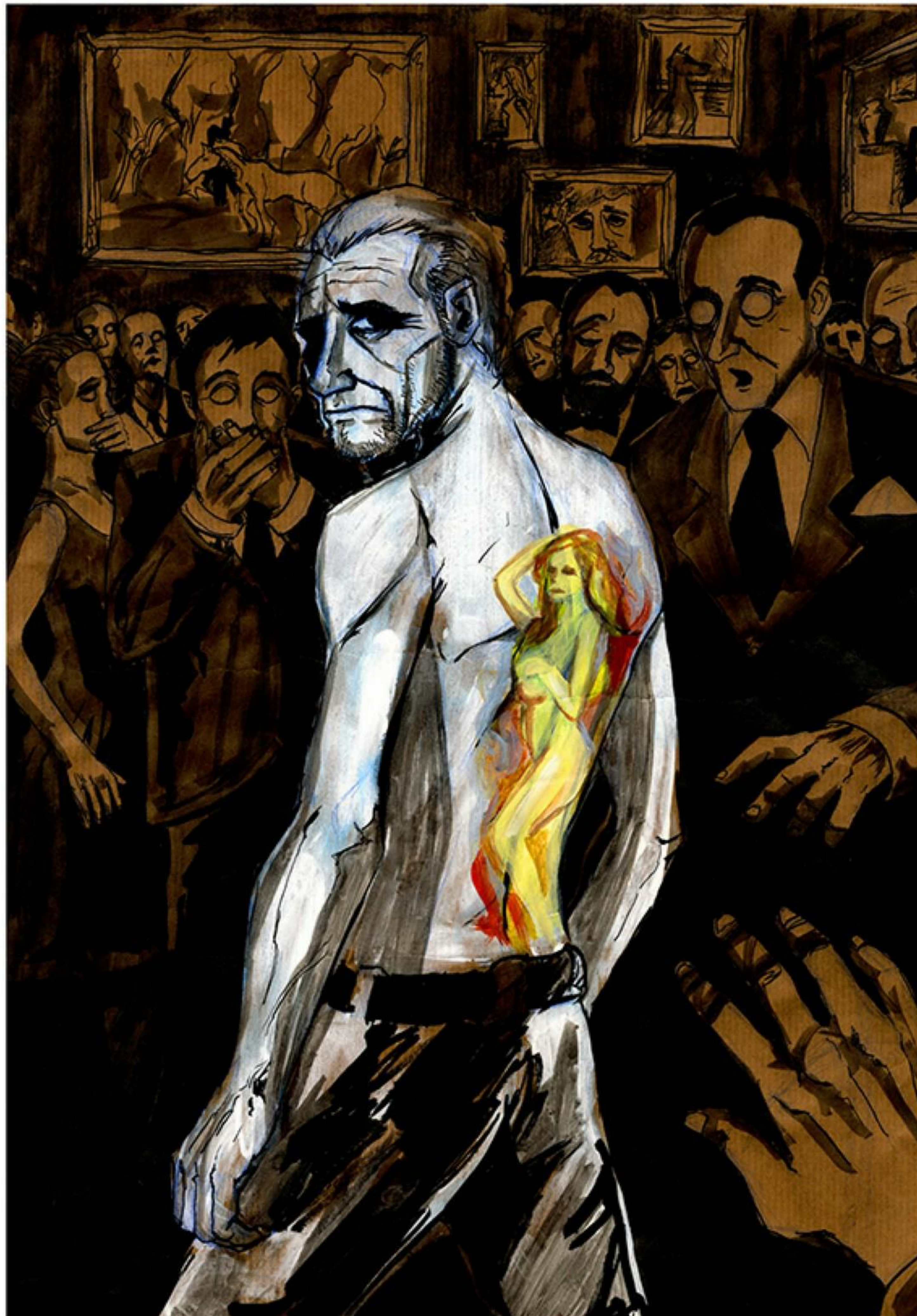


SKIN

ROALD DAHL



2. Incidents like Guerrero's are common on international airlines.
3. Adequate measures are taken to provide security in flights.

VII. Give a summary of the facts of the story. Use these phrases.

the story is about...; the story deals with...; the story speaks about the morality of...; the story describes the life of...; the story shows that...; the story ends in...

### Roald Dahl Biography

Children of all ages have read and enjoyed books by Roald Dahl. Many of his stories, such as *"Charlie and the Chocolate Factory"* and *"James and the Giant Peach"*, have become classics in their own time.

Roald was born on September 13, 1916 in Llandaff, Wales. Roald attended St. Peter's Preparatory School in Weston from ages nine to thirteen. He adjusted to school life, but he never learned to like it. In *"Boy"* he describes savage beatings, sadistic headmasters, prejudiced teachers, and even an abusive dormitory Matron.

Schoolmates remembered him as a tall, soft-faced boy, not especially popular but very close to the few boys who became his friends. He was good at sports like cricket and swimming, but academically he was toward the bottom of his class. One of his main hobbies was reading, and some of his favorite novelists were the adventure writers Rudyard Kipling, Captain Marryat, H. Rider Haggard, and G.A. Henty. Their books emphasized a kind of heroism and masculinity that would later influence both Dahl's life and his own writing.

After completing his education at Repton, Dahl decided that he wanted a career that would take him to "wonderful faraway places like Africa or China" (*"Boy"*, 166). He won a coveted position with the Shell Company and spent two years training in England. Soon after he was posted to East Africa and started off on the two-week sea voyage to get there. This voyage marks the end of *"Boy"* and the beginning of *"Going Solo"*. *"Going Solo"* describes many of the exciting adventures Dahl lived through.

In 1939, it became clear to Dahl that something big was coming. It was World War II. Soon all the Englishmen in the territory were rounded up. This experience prompted Dahl to formally join the RAF (Royal Air Force) and learn to fly warplanes. Unfortunately Dahl's very first venture into combat territory resulted in his famous 1940 crash in the Libyan desert. After convalescing for months in various army hospitals, Dahl was finally deemed fit to resume flying

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duties again in the spring of 1941. Then he began to get blinding headaches he was invalided back home to Britain. His career in the RAF was over.

Thus, in 1941, Roald Dahl went home to England. He wasn't there for long, though. Through his friendship with artist Matthew Smith, he became acquainted with some very important men in the British government. Dahl was a cultivated, forceful young injured pilot who seemed able to talk about anything. It wasn't long before he was shipped off to the United States to help with the British War Effort as "assistant air attaché".

One of Dahl's first duties in America was to get close to as many well-placed people as possible. Newspaper-owner Charles Marsh was one of these, and he and Dahl struck up an immediate friendship. Another duty was to help create a kind of British propaganda to keep America interested in the war and sympathetic to Britain's effort. Famous English author C. S. Forester asked Dahl to tell him his own story, so that he could write it up. Dahl thought it easier to put something on paper himself, and the result was so good that Forester decided not to change a thing. The finished story appeared anonymously in *The Saturday Evening Post* in August 1942 under the title "*Shot Down Over Libya*".

Time passed and Dahl became more popular among Washington's rich and famous. He wrote a story called "*Gremlin Lore*" about the mythical creatures that supposedly sabotaged RAF planes. Walt Disney decided to turn Dahl's story into an animated feature called "*The Gremlins*".

If "*The Gremlins*" never reached the big screen, the experience certainly made Dahl's name as a writer. By the fall of 1944 he had a literary agent, Ann Watkins, and he had published a number of stories in American magazines: "*Shot Down Over Libya*" in *The Saturday Evening Post*; "*The Gremlins*" both in *Cosmopolitan* and in the book form; "*The Sword*" in *The Atlantic Monthly*; "*Katina*" and "*Only This*" in the *Ladies' Home Journal*; and "*Beware of the Dog*" in *Harper's*.

In 1945 Dahl moved back home to Amersham, England. He enjoyed the rustic country life, making friends with some of the working-class men in the village. The novel Dahl wrote, "*Sometime Never*", was published in the United States in 1948 by Scribner's, and in England a year later by Collins. There's no easy way to put this: the book was a total flop. It was almost an adult version of the Gremlins story, beginning with the Battle of Britain and continuing on to the end of the world. Despite its utter failure, the book is remarkable for being the first book about nuclear war to be published in the United States after Hiroshima.

In 1953 Dahl married an actress Patricia Neal, whom he had first met at a party in 1951. She was a promising Warner Bros. Star who had recently ended a much-publicized affair with Gary Cooper. They had five children together and

he attributes his success as a writer of children's books to them. "Had I not had children of my own, I would have never written books for children, nor would I have been capable of doing so."

"Boy" – *"Tales of Childhood"* and *"Going Solo"* are accounts of Dahl's childhood experiences which explain where some of the ideas for his books originated. Roald Dahl and his siblings were raised to be very conscious of their Norwegian heritage. Not only did his mother speak the language around the house, she also read them Norse myths and took them on annual trips to Norway to visit relatives. This heritage is most evident in Dahl's book *"The Witches"*, but its influence can be seen in other books as well.

*"Danny the Champion of the World," "Matilda,"* and Roald Dahl's *"Revolting Rhymes"* are examples of stories resulting from Dahl's beliefs that "The writer for children must be a jokey sort of fellow... he must be unconventional and inventive".

Dahl was also enjoying a measure of commercial success now. The sixty-year-old publisher Alfred Knopf had recently discovered some of Dahl's short stories and was eager to sign him to a deal. The collection Dahl later delivered in 1953 included such tales as *"Taste," "My Lady Love, My Dove," "Skin"* and *"Dip in the Pool"*. Also included were four country stories gathered under the sub-title *"Claud's Dog"*. The resulting book was entitled *"Someone Like You"* and received some very good reviews: "At disconcertingly long intervals, the complete short-story writer comes along... Tension is his business; give him a surprise denouement, he'll give you a story leading up to it. His name in this instance is Roald Dahl" (James Kelly, quoted in Treglown; 119).

In 1983, Roald Dahl and Patricia Neal divorced after thirty years of marriage. Dahl quickly remarried Felicity Dahl, with whom he had fallen in love and carried on an affair for some time. Thus, the last years of his life were relatively happy and productive, and some of his best books were written during this period: *"The BFG," "The Witches"* and *"Matilda"*. Roald Dahl died on November 23, 1990 in Oxford, England. He was buried in Great Missenden.

### SKIN

(Roald Dahl)

I

(1) That winter was a long time going. A freezing wind blew through the streets of the city, and overhead the snow clouds moved across the sky.

The old man who was called Drioli shuffled painfully along the sidewalk of the rue de Rivoli. He was cold and miserable. He moved

glancing without any interest at the things in the shop windows – perfume, silk ties and shirts, diamonds, furniture, books. Then a picture gallery. He had always liked picture galleries. This one had a single canvas on display in the window. He stopped to look at it. Suddenly, there came to him a slight movement of the memory<sup>1</sup>, a distant recollection of something, somewhere, he had seen before. He looked again. It was a landscape, a group of trees leaning over to one side as if blown by wind. Attached to the frame there was a little plaque, and on this it said: CHAIM SOUTINE (1894 – 1943)<sup>2</sup>.

(2) Drioli stared at the picture, wondering vaguely what there was about it that seemed familiar. Crazy painting, he thought. Very strange and crazy – but I like it... Chaim Soutine... Soutine... "By God!" he cried suddenly. "My little friend, with a picture in the finest shop in Paris! Just imagine that!"

The old man pressed his face closer to the window. He could remember the boy – yes, quite clearly he could remember him. But when? The rest of it was not so easy to recollect. It was so long ago. How long? Twenty – no, more like thirty years, wasn't it? Wait a minute. Yes – it was the year before the war, the first war, 1913. That was it. And this Soutine, this ugly little boy whom he had liked – almost loved – for no reason at all that he could think of except that he could paint.

(3) And how he could paint! It was coming back more clearly now. Where was it the boy had lived?

The Cité Falguière<sup>3</sup>, that was it! Then there was the studio with the single chair in it, and the dirty red sofa that the boy had used for sleeping; the drunken parties, the cheap white wine, the furious quarrels, and always, always the sad face of the boy thinking over his work.

It was odd Drioli thought, how easily it all came back to him now, how each single small remembered fact seemed instantly to remind him of another.

(4) There was that nonsense with the tattoo, for instance. Now, that was a mad thing if ever there was one. How had it started? Ah, yes – he had got rich one day, that was it, and he had bought lots of wine. He could see himself now as he entered the studio with the parcel of bottles under his arm – the boy sitting before the easel, and his (Drioli's) own wife standing in the centre of the room, posing for her picture.

single

"Tonight we shall celebrate," he said. "We shall have a little celebration, us three."

"What is it that we celebrate?" the boy asked, without looking up. "Is it that you have decided to divorce your wife so she can marry me?"

"No," Drioli said. "We celebrate because today I have made a great sum of money with my work."

"And I have made nothing. We can celebrate that also."

(5) The girl came across the room to look at the painting. Drioli came over also, holding a bottle in one hand, a glass in the other.

"No!" the boy shouted. "Please – no!" He snatched the canvas from the easel and stood it against the wall. But Drioli had seen it.

"It's marvellous. I like all the others that you do, it's marvellous. I love them all."

"The trouble is," the boy said gloomily, "that in themselves they are not nourishing. I cannot eat them."

"But still they are marvellous." Drioli handed him a glass of the pale-yellow wine. "Drink it," he said. "It will make you happy."

Never, he thought, had he known a more unhappy person, or one with a gloomier face.

"Give me some more," the boy said. "If we are to celebrate<sup>4</sup> then let us do it properly."

"Tonight we shall drink as much as we possibly can," Drioli said. "I am exceptionally rich. I think perhaps I should go out now and buy some more bottles. How many shall I get?"

"Six more," the boy said. "Two for each."

"Good. I shall go now and fetch them."

"And I will help you."

In the nearest café Drioli bought six bottles of white wine, and they carried them back to the studio. Then they sat down again and continued to drink.

"It is only the very wealthy, who can afford to celebrate in this manner."

"That is true," the boy said. "Isn't that true, Josie?"

"Of course."

"Beautiful wine," Drioli said. "It is a privilege to drink it."

Slowly, methodically, they set about getting themselves drunk.<sup>5</sup> The process was routine, but all the same there was a certain ceremony to be observed.

(6) "Listen," Drioli said at length. "I have a tremendous idea. I would like to have a picture, a lovely picture. —...It is this. I want you to paint a picture on my skin, on my back. Then I want you to tattoo over what you have painted so that it will be there always."

"You have crazy ideas," the boy said.

"I will teach you how to use the tattoo. It is easy. A child could do it."

"You are quite mad. What is it you want?"

"I will teach you in two minutes!"

"Impossible!"

"Are you saying I do not know what I am talking about?"

"All I am saying," the boy told him, "is that you are drunk and this is a drunken idea."

(7) "We could have my wife for a model. A study of Josie<sup>6</sup> upon my back."

"It is no good idea," the boy said. "And I could not possibly manage the tattoo."

"It is simple. I will undertake to teach you in two minutes. You will see. I shall go now and bring the instruments."

In half an hour Drioli was back. "I have brought everything," he cried, waving a brown suitcase. "All the necessities of the tattooist are here in this bag."

He placed the bag on the table, opened it, and laid out the electric needles and the small bottles of coloured inks. He plugged in the electric needle, then he took the instrument in his hand and pressed a switch. He threw off his jacket and rolled up his left sleeve. "Now look. Watch me and I will show you how easy it is. I will make a design on my arm, here. ... See how easy it is... see how I draw a picture of a dog here upon my arm..."

The boy was intrigued. "Now let me practise a little — on your arm."

With the buzzing needle he began to draw blue lines upon Drioli's arm. "It is simple," he said. "It is like drawing with pen and ink. There is no difference except that it is slower."

"There is nothing to it. Are you ready? Shall we begin?"

"At once."

"The model!" cried Drioli. "Come on, Josie!" He was in a bustle of enthusiasm<sup>7</sup> now arranging everything, like a child preparing for some exciting game. "Where will you have her? Where shall she stand?"

"Let her be standing there, by my dressing table. Let her be brushing her hair. I will paint her with her hair down over her shoulders and her brushing it."

"Tremendous. You are a genius."

(8) "First," the boy said, "I shall make an ordinary painting. Then if it pleases me, I shall tattoo over it." With a wide brush he began to paint upon the naked skin of the man's back.

"Be still now! Be still!" His concentration, as soon as he began to paint, was so great that it appeared somehow to neutralize his drunkenness.

"All right. That's all," he said at last to the girl.

Far into the small hours of the morning<sup>8</sup> the boy worked. Drioli could remember that when the artist finally stepped back and said, "It is finished," there was daylight outside and the sound of people walking in the street.

"I want to see it," Drioli said. The boy held up a mirror, and Drioli craned his neck to look.

(9) "Good God!" he cried. It was a startling sight. The whole of his back was a blaze of colour – gold and green and blue and black and red. The tattoo was applied so heavily it looked almost like an impasto. The portrait was quite alive; it contained so much characteristic of Soutine's other works.

"It's tremendous!"

"I rather like it myself." The boy stood back, examining it critically. "You know," he added, "I think it's good enough for me to sign." And taking up the machine again, he inscribed his name in red ink on the right-hand side, over the place where Drioli's kidney was.

## II

(10) The old man who was called Drioli was standing in a sort of trance, staring at the painting in the window of the picture-dealer's shop. It had been so long ago, all that – almost as though it had happened in another life.

And the boy that after returning had questioned

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Drioli stood

(13) "If yo yourself out of

And the boy? What had become of him? He could remember now that after returning from the war – the first war – he had missed him and had questioned Josie.

"Where is my little painter?"

"He is gone," she had answered. "I do not know where."

"Perhaps he will return."

"Perhaps he will. Who knows?"

That was the last time they had mentioned him. Shortly afterwards they had moved to Le Havre where there were more sailors and business was better. Those were the pleasant years, the years between the wars, with the small shop near the docks and the comfortable rooms and always enough work.

(11) Then had come the second war, and Josie being killed, and the Germans arriving<sup>9</sup>, and that was the finish of his business. No one had wanted pictures on their arms any more after that. And by that time he was too old for any other kind of work. In desperation he had made his way back to Paris, hoping vaguely that things would be easier in the big city. But they were not.

And now, after the war was over, he possessed neither the means nor the energy to start up his small business again. It wasn't very easy for an old man to know what to do, especially when one did not like to beg. Yet how else could he keep alive?

(12) Well, he thought, still staring at the picture. So that is my little friend. He put his face closer to the window and looked into the gallery. On the walls he could see many other pictures and all seemed to be the work of the same artist. There were a great number of people strolling around. Obviously it was a special exhibition.

On a sudden impulse, Drioli turned, pushed open the door of the gallery and went in.

It was a long room with a thick wine-coloured carpet, and by God how beautiful and warm it was! There were all these people strolling about looking at the pictures, well-washed dignified people, each of whom held a catalogue in the hand. He heard a voice beside him saying, "What is it you want?"

Drioli stood still.

(13) "If you please," the man in a black suit was saying, "take yourself out of my gallery."

"Am I not permitted to look at the pictures?"

"I have asked you to leave."

Drioli stood his ground.<sup>10</sup> He felt suddenly, overwhelmingly outraged.

"Let us not have trouble," the man was saying. "Come on now, this way." He put a fat white hand on Drioli's arm and began to push him firmly to the door.

That did it.<sup>11</sup> "Take your goddam hands off me!"<sup>12</sup> Drioli shouted. His voice rang clear down the long gallery and all the heads turned around as one – all the startled faces stared down the length of the room at the person who had made this noise. The people stood still, watching the struggle. Their faces expressed only a mild interest, and seemed to be saying.<sup>13</sup> "It's all right. There's no danger to us. It's being taken care of."<sup>14</sup>

(14) "I, too!" Drioli was shouting. "I, too, have a picture by this painter! He was my friend and I have a picture which he gave me!"

"He's mad."

"Someone should call the police."

With a twist of the body Drioli suddenly shook off the man and before anyone could stop him he was running down the gallery shouting, "I'll show you! I'll show you! I'll show you!" He flung off his overcoat, then his jacket and shirt, and he turned so that his naked back was towards the people.

"There!" he cried, breathing quickly. "You see? There it is!"

There was a sudden absolute silence in the room, each person arrested in what he was doing<sup>15</sup>, standing motionless in a kind of shocked, uneasy surprise. They were staring at the tattooed picture. It was still there, the colours as bright as ever.

(15) Somebody said, "My God, but it is!"

"His early manner, yes?"

"It is fantastic, fantastic!"

"And look, it is signed!"

"Old one, when was this done?"

"In 1913," Drioli said, without turning around. "In the autumn of 1913."

"Who taught Soutine to tattoo?"

"I taught him."

"And the woman?"

"She was my wife."

*продураивать экзоты там*  
(16) The gallery owner was pushing through the crowd towards Drioli. He was calm now, deadly serious, making a smile with his mouth. "Monsieur," he said, "I will buy it. I said I will buy it, Monsieur."

"How can you buy it?" Drioli asked softly.

"I will give two hundred thousand francs for it."

"Don't do it!" someone murmured in the crowd. "It is worth twenty times as much."

Drioli opened his mouth to speak. No words came, so he shut it; then he opened it again and said slowly, "But how can I sell it?" He lifted his hands, let them drop helplessly to his sides. "Monsieur, how can I possibly sell it?" All the sadness in the world was in his voice.

"Yes!" they were saying in the crowd. "How can he sell it? It is part of himself!"

"Listen!" the dealer said, coming up close. "I will help you. I will make you rich. Together we shall make some private arrangement over this picture, no?"

(17) Drioli watched him with worried eyes. "But how can you buy it, Monsieur? What will you do with it when you have bought it? Where will you keep it? Where will you keep it tonight? And where tomorrow?"

"Ah, where will I keep it? Yes, where will I keep it? Well, now... It would seem," he said, "that if I take the picture, I take you also. That is a disadvantage. The picture itself is of no value until you are dead. How old are you, my friend?"

"Sixty-one."

"But you are perhaps not very healthy, no?" The dealer looked Drioli up and down, slowly, like a farmer examining an old horse.

(18) "I do not like this," Drioli said moving away. "Quite honestly, Monsieur, I do not like it." He moved straight into the arms of a tall man who put out his hands and caught him gently by the shoulders.

"Listen, my friend," the stranger said, still smiling. "Do you like to swim and to lie in the sun?"

Drioli looked up at him, rather startled.

"Do you like fine food and red wine from the great châteaux of Bordeaux?"<sup>16</sup> The man was still smiling, showing strong white teeth with a flash of gold among them. He spoke in a soft manner, one gloved hand still resting on Drioli's shoulder. "Do you like such things?"

"Well – yes," Drioli answered, still greatly puzzled. "Of course."

"Have you ever had a shoe made especially for your own foot?"

"No."

"You would like that?"

"Well..."

"And a man who will shave you in the mornings and trim your hair?"

Drioli simply stood and stared.

"And a plump attractive girl to manicure the nails of your fingers?"

Someone in the crowd giggled.

"And a bell beside your bed to call a maid to bring you breakfast in the morning? Would you like these things, my friend? Do they appeal to you?"

Drioli stood still and looked at him.

(19) "You see, I am the owner of the Hotel Bristol in Cannes. I now invite you to come down there and live as my guest for the rest of your life in luxury and comfort." The man paused, allowing his listener time to digest this cheerful prospect.

"Your only duty – shall I call it your pleasure – will be to spend your time on my beach in bathing trunks, walking among my guests, sunning yourself, swimming, drinking cocktails. You would like that?"

There was no answer.

"Don't you see – all the guests will thus be able to observe this fascinating picture by Soutine. You will become famous, and men will say, 'Look, there is the fellow with ten million francs upon his back.' You like this idea, Monsieur? It pleases you?"

Drioli looked up at the tall man in the canary gloves. He said slowly, "But do you really mean it?"

"Of course I mean it."

(20) "Wait," the dealer interrupted. "See here, old one. Here is the answer to our problem. I will buy the picture, and I will arrange with a surgeon to remove the skin from your back, and then you will be able to go off on your own<sup>17</sup> and enjoy the great sum of money I shall give you for it."

"With no skin on my back?"

"No, no, please! You misunderstand. This surgeon will put a new piece of skin in the place of the old one. It is simple."

"Could he do that?"

"There is nothing to it."

"Impossible such a major you, my friend"

"It would be"

"Naturally through."

"In the na faces of the another man's be heard say money<sup>18</sup>, he a few people la"

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"Impossible!" said the man with the canary gloves. "He's too old for such a major skin-removing operation. It would kill him. It would kill you, my friend."

"It would kill me?"

"Naturally. You would never survive. Only the picture would come through."

"In the name of God!" Drioli cried. He looked around terrified at the faces of the people watching him, and in the silence that followed, another man's voice, speaking quietly from the back of the group, could be heard saying, "Perhaps, if one were to offer this old man enough money<sup>18</sup>, he might consent to kill himself on the spot. Who knows?" A few people laughed. The dealer moved his feet uneasily on the carpet.

(21) "Come on," the tall man said, smiling his broad white smile. "You and I will go and have a good dinner and we can talk about it some more while we eat. How's that? Are you hungry?"

Drioli watched him, frowning. He didn't like the man's long flexible neck, or the way he craned it forward at you when he spoke, like a snake.

"Roast duck and Chambertin<sup>19</sup>," the man was saying. "And perhaps a soufflé aux marrons<sup>20</sup>, light and frothy."

Drioli's eyes turned up towards the ceiling, his mouth watered.

"How do you like your duck?" the man went on. "Do you like it very brown and crisp outside, or shall it be..."

"I am coming," Drioli said quickly. Already he had picked up his shirt and was pulling it hurriedly over his head. "Wait for me, Monsieur. I am coming." And within a minute he had disappeared out of the gallery with his new patron.

(22) It wasn't more than a few weeks later that a picture by Soutine, of a woman's head, painted in an unusual manner, nicely framed and heavily varnished, turned up for sale in Buenos Aires. That – and the fact that there is no hotel in Cannes called Bristol – causes one to wonder a little, and to pray for the old man's health, and to hope strongly that wherever he may be at this moment, there is a plump attractive girl to manicure the nails of his fingers, and a maid to bring him his breakfast in bed in the mornings.

# WORDS AND PHRASES

## I

- (1) **shuffle** *v* зд. волочить ноги, идти шаркающей походкой  
**miserable** *a* несчастный  
**canvas** *n* холст, полотно  
**recollection** *n* воспоминание  
**attached** *p. p.* прикрепленный  
**plaque** *n* зд. пластинка
- (2) **vaguely** *adv* смутно  
**ugly** *a* некрасивый, безобразный
- (3) **studio** *n* ателье, мастерская художника  
**quarrel** *n* ссора  
**odd** *a* странный  
**remind** *v* напоминать
- (4) **tattoo** *n* татуировка  
**easel** *n* мольберт  
**celebrate** *v* праздновать  
**divorce** *v* разводиться
- (5) **snatch** *v* зд. срывать  
**marvellous** *a* изумительный  
**nourishing** *a* питательный  
**exceptionally** *adv* исключительно  
**fetch** *v* принести  
**routine** *a* обычный
- (6) **tremendous** *a* зд. потрясающий
- (7) **undertake** *v* брать на себя  
 обязательство, браться за ч.-л.  
**wave** *v* размахивать  
**needle** *n* игла  
**plug in** *v* включаться в (электросеть)  
**roll up one's sleeve** закатать рукав  
**design** *n* зд. рисунок  
**buzz** *v* жужжать
- (8) **genius** *n* гений  
**brush** *n* кисть  
**neutralize** *v* нейтрализовать
- (9) **crane one's neck** вытягивать шею, чтобы лучше рассмотреть что-л.

- startling sight** поразительное зрелище  
**blaze of colour** великолепие красок  
**impasto** *n* густо наложенные краски  
**inscribe** *v* надписывать  
**kidney** *n* (мед.) почка

## II

- (10) **in a sort of trance** в каком-то оцепенении  
**picture-dealer** *n* продавец картин  
**miss** *v* зд. скучать
- (11) **in desperation** в отчаянии  
**possess** *v* иметь  
**means** *n* средства  
**beg** *v* просить милостыню  
**keep alive** зд. выжить
- (12) **stare (at)** *v* пристально смотреть (на)  
**stroll around** прогуливаться  
**obviously** *adv* очевидно  
**on impulse** под влиянием порыва  
**wine-coloured** темно-красный  
**dignified** *a* обладающий чувством собственного достоинства  
**stand still** зд. остановиться
- (13) **permit** *v* разрешать  
**overwhelmingly outraged** возмущенный до глубины души
- (14) **twist** *n* поворот, резкое движение  
**shake off** *v* стряхнуть, сбросить  
**fling (off)** *v* сбрасывать
- (16) **push through the crowd** пробираться сквозь толпу  
**deadly serious** очень серьезный  
**softly** *adv* зд. тихо

- murmur** *v* пробормотать  
**sadness** *n* печаль  
 (17) **disadvantage** *n* неудобство,  
       помеха  
**value** *n* ценность  
**look smb up and down**  
       осматривать кого-л. с ног до  
       головы  
 (18) **honestly** *adv* зд. серьезно  
**gently** *adv* мягко  
**lie in the sun** загорать  
**puzzled** *a* удивленный  
**trim** *v* подстригать  
**manicure nails** делать маникюр  
**giggle** *v* хихикать  
**appeal** *v* нравиться  
 (19) **luxury** *n* роскошь  
**digest** *v* переварить, осмыслить  
**bathing trunks** плавки  
**sun oneself** *v* загорать  
**observe** *v* зд. видеть, замечать  
**fascinating** *a* зд. великолепный  
**canary gloves** перчатки  
       канареечного цвета

- (20) **remove** *v* зд. снимать  
**misunderstand** *v* неправильно  
       понять  
**major** *a* зд. сложный  
**come through** зд. выступить  
**terrified** *p.p.* в ужасе  
**consent** *v* соглашаться  
**on the spot** на месте  
**uneasily** *adv* с чувством  
       неловкости  
 (21) **frown** *v* хмуриться  
**flexible** *a* гибкий, подвижный  
**snake** *n* змея  
**frothy** *a* пенистый  
**mouth watered** слюнки потекли  
**crisp** *a* хрустящий  
 (22) **disappear** *v* исчезать  
**framed** *a* вставленный в рамку  
**varnish heavily** покрывать  
       толстым слоем лака  
**turn up for sale** появиться на  
       продажу  
**pray** *v* молиться

## NOTES

<sup>1</sup> Suddenly, there came to him a slight movement of the memory – Suddenly he remembered that...

<sup>2</sup> Chaim Soutine (1894–1943) – Хаим Сутин (a painter of the Expressionist School).

<sup>3</sup> Cité Falguière – the place of Falguière.

<sup>4</sup> If we are to celebrate then... – If we want to celebrate...

<sup>5</sup> ...they set about getting themselves drunk – ...they began drinking to make themselves drunk.

<sup>6</sup> A study of Josie... – a portrait of Josie...

<sup>7</sup> He was in a bustle of enthusiasm – He was very enthusiastic about the whole thing.

<sup>8</sup> far into the small hours of the morning – till very early in the morning.

<sup>9</sup> ... and Josie being killed, and the Germans arriving – and Josie had been killed and the Germans had come.

<sup>10</sup> Drioli stood his ground – Drioli insisted that...  
<sup>11</sup> That did it. – That was enough to make Drioli very angry.  
<sup>12</sup> "Take your goddam hands off me!" – Don't touch me!  
<sup>13</sup> Their faces seemed to be saying... – Казалось, выражение их лиц говорило, что...

<sup>14</sup> It's being taken care of – Things are being put right.  
<sup>15</sup> ...each person arrested in what he was doing – everybody was transfixed (все замерли).

<sup>16</sup> châteaux of Bordeaux – замки провинции Бордо (Франция), славящейся своими винами.

<sup>17</sup> I will arrange with a surgeon to remove the skin from your back, and then you will be able to go off on your own. – I'll take you to a surgeon (хирург), he will remove the skin with the portrait from your back and then you'll be free to do as you please.

<sup>18</sup> Perhaps, if one were to offer this old man enough money – Perhaps, if somebody offered this old man enough money.

<sup>19</sup> Roast duck and Chambertin – жареная утка и шамбертен (марка вина).

<sup>20</sup> a soufflé aux marrons – суфле из каштанов.

### COMPREHENSION ACTIVITIES

I. Recall the main events of the story read.

II. Answer these comprehension questions.

1. Why was Drioli cold and miserable?
2. Whom did he remember as he pressed his face closer to the window?
3. What period did the incident of the tattoo go back to?
4. What was Drioli's life like at that time? What did he do for a living? What did they celebrate?
5. What did Drioli want to celebrate?
6. How did the idea of a tattoo on his back come to Drioli's mind?
7. How did the picture work out? Was it really marvellous?
8. What happened to Drioli, his wife and Soutine in the following years?
9. Why did Drioli decide to enter the gallery? What did he see there?
10. Why was he asked to leave the place at once?
11. How did Drioli reveal the fact that he had Soutine's picture on his back?
12. What was the first reaction of those present?
13. Why did the gallery owner suggest

buying the picture on Drioli's back? How did he word his <sup>предложение</sup> proposal? 14. How did Drioli take the proposal? Did he agree at once? 15. Drioli received an alternative proposal at once, didn't he? What was it? Why did he accept it? 16. Was the picture on Drioli's back lost to the public?

### III... Give Russian equivalents of the following phrases.

Miserable (1), to seem familiar (2), to celebrate (4), nourishing (5), exceptionally rich (5), a crazy idea (6), to make an ordinary painting (8), the small hours of the morning (8), to examine smth critically (9), a special exhibition (12), dignified people (12), to be permitted (13), to stand one's ground (13), to call the police (14), deadly serious (16), to be worth (16), to make a private arrangement (16), to lie in the sun (18), to be puzzled (18), to live in luxury and comfort (19), to remove the skin (20), to misunderstand (20), to survive (20), his mouth watered (21), nicely framed (22).

### IV. Find facts from the story to support these statements.

1. Drioli always loved Soutine and highly appreciated his talent. 2. It was a crazy idea to have a picture tattooed on Drioli's back. 3. The picture was really one of Soutine's masterpieces. 4. Soutine was a great artist recognized by the artistic world. 5. Only very wealthy people visited the show of Chaim Soutine's works. 6. The gallery owner changed his attitude to Drioli the moment he saw the picture on the man's back. 7. The tall man was very clever in his attempts to persuade Drioli. 8. This is a very sad story.

### V. Describe these episodes. Make use of key words and phrases from Exercise III wherever possible.

1. Drioli recollects the scene of the tattoo. 2. Drioli <sup>потерял из виду</sup> loses sight of the talented boy. 3. Drioli enters the gallery. 4. Drioli shows the picture on his back and watches for the reaction. 5. The gallery owner and the tall man compete for Drioli. 6. Drioli accepts the tall man's proposal.

VI. Comment upon these statements.

1. Drioli went into the gallery because he was cold and miserable rather than because he was moved by love for Soutine and recollections of the past.
2. Drioli was suspicious of the gallery owner and fully trusted the tall man.
3. Drioli accepted the tall man's proposal because he was driven to despair. He did not realize what lay behind it.
4. Drioli died a natural death.
5. Art is something that has nothing to do with big business.

VII. Discussion. Critical thinking.

Discuss these questions in pairs, small groups, or as a class.

1. Drioli was affected by the war, wasn't he? Can you say whether many people were affected by the war in one way or another?
2. Why was Soutine unhappy about life? He knew he was a good artist, didn't he?
3. Do you think Drioli's sad end was inevitable? Can you explain why? Speak on social aspects of the problem.
4. What life do many young artists live in the world before their fame is established?
5. Speak on the problem of unemployment and its effect on people.

VIII. Give a summary of the facts of the story. The following phrases may be helpful.

The story introduces us to the events...; the attraction of this story lies in the fact that...; we might as well mention here...; among other things...; the end of the story is suggestive enough because...

**P. G. Wodehouse**

Biography

What's surprising is that P. G. Wodehouse (1881-1975), the greatest comedy writer English language has seen, is virtually unknown to our reading circles.

PELHAM GRENVILLE WODEHOUSE, (to friends - Plum) (b. Oct. 15, 1881, Guildford, Surrey, SE Eng. - d. Feb. 14, (on St. Valentine day), 1975, Southampton, N.Y., U.S.)